

IPUMS

IPUMS, originally the *Integrated Public Use Microdata Series*,^[1] is the world's largest individual-level population database. IPUMS consists of microdata samples from United States (***IPUMS-USA***) and international (***IPUMS-International***) census records, as well as data from U.S. and international surveys. The records are converted into a consistent format and made available to researchers through a web-based data dissemination and analysis system.^[2]

IPUMS is housed at the Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation (ISRDI), an interdisciplinary research center at the University of Minnesota, under the direction of Professor Steven Ruggles.^[3]

Description

IPUMS includes all persons enumerated in the United States censuses from 1850 to 1950 (though, the 1890 census is missing because it was destroyed in a fire) and from the American Community Survey since 2000 and the Current Population Survey since 1962. IPUMS includes household-level data for United States Censuses from 1790 to 1840, due to the first six censuses only including the name of the head of household, with tallied household totals following.^[4] IPUMS provides consistent variable names, coding schemes, and documentation across all the samples, facilitating the analysis of long-term change.^[5]

IPUMS-International includes countries from Africa, Asia, Europe, and Latin America for 1960 forward. The database currently includes more than a billion individuals enumerated in 365 censuses from 94 countries around the world.^[6] IPUMS-International converts census microdata for multiple countries into a consistent format, allowing for comparisons across countries and time periods. Special efforts are made to simplify use of the data while losing no meaningful information. Comprehensive documentation is provided in a coherent form to facilitate comparative analyses of social and economic change.^[7]

Additional databases in the IPUMS family include the:

- North Atlantic Population Project (NAPP)^[8]
- IPUMS National Historical Geographic Information System (NHGIS)^[9]
- IPUMS Health Surveys ^[10]
- IPUMS Global Health ^[11]
- IPUMS Time Use ^[12]

The *Journal of American History* described the effort as "One of the great archival projects of the past two decades."^[13] Liens Socio, the French portal for the social sciences, gave IPUMS the only "best site" designation that has gone to any non-French website, writing "IPUMS est un projet absolument extraordinaire...époustouflante [mind-blowing]!" ^[14]

The official motto of IPUMS is "use it for good, never for evil."^[15] All public IPUMS data and documentation are available online free of charge.

References

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5. Steven Ruggles (2014). "Big Microdata for Population Research" (http://users.hist.umn.edu/~ruggles/Articles/Big_Microdata.pdf) (PDF). *Demography*. **51** (1): 287–297. doi:10.1007/s13524-013-0240-2 (<https://doi.org/10.1007%2Fs13524-013-0240-2>). PMC 3949202 (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3949202>). PMID 24014182 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/24014182>).
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11. "IPUMS Global Health" (<https://www.ipums.org/globalhealth.shtml>).
12. "IPUMS Time Use" (<https://www.ipums.org/timeuse.shtml>).
13. Joel Perlmann (2003). "IPUMS". *Journal of American History*. **90**: 339–340. doi:10.2307/3659961 (<https://doi.org/10.2307%2F3659961>). JSTOR 3659961 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/3659961>).
14. "Liens Socio" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190608062236/https://www.liens-socio.org/>). Archived from the original (<https://www.liens-socio.org/>) on 2019-06-08. Retrieved 2019-05-31.
15. "Ipums USA" (<https://usa.ipums.org/usa/>).

External links

- Official website (<https://www.ipums.org/>)
 - Institute for Social Research and Data Innovation (<https://isrdi.umn.edu/>)
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